

Joseph (Joey) Clark III, JD, MBA

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SUMMARY

Strategic operator with 10+ years bridging venture capital, banking, and government. A JD, MBA, and MPP in a single operator means legal and contractual fluency, financial rigor, and policy thinking arrive together, and the result is someone who can move from ideation to an executive briefing without losing the thread. The leaders I've worked with tend to hand me things they can't hand to most people. I show up prepared, I read the room, and when they step away from the table, they know it's handled.

Seeking Chief of Staff and senior operator roles where the work is multi-faceted and the gap between vision and execution needs closing.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Independent Consultant

Washington, DC | February 2026 - Present

Fundraising Operations: Served as fractional fundraising operations lead for a stealth tech venture creation fund (\$150M-200M target)

- Built fundraising strategy and execution roadmap, prepared Korean national fund-of-funds (FoF) application, assessed SSBCI (US state FoF) program eligibility across multiple states, built LP meeting intelligence infrastructure and fund's 2026 conference strategy.

Go-to-Market Strategy: Served as founding business development operator for Lex Generalis, an Anzu-backed legaltech startup

- Developed GTM strategy and partnership positioning from pre-launch through early commercialization.

SVP & Principal | Anzu Partners

Washington, DC | September 2024 - February 2026

Capital Formation: Built network of 20 preferred lenders across venture debt, equipment and specialty lending

- Designed standardized evaluation frameworks and data room architecture that enabled pipeline management. Enabled \$22M in closed financing (76% above \$12.5M annual target) during a period of significant LP and VC capital contraction.

Strategic Partnerships: Deployed deep ecosystem relationships to drive partnerships and capital solutions for portfolio companies

- Built and systematically qualified prospect lists of 10-300 corporate partners, equity investors, and potential acquirers per engagement, converting warm relationships into structured deal pipelines.
- Managed engagements from initial outreach through due diligence to term sheet negotiation in a market where equity capital had largely frozen and cold outreach rarely converted.

Executive Support & Operating Infrastructure: Designed and implemented weekly strategic briefing system for Managing Partners

- Structured updates across state of play, immediate decisions required, meeting summaries, portfolio company progress, ecosystem initiatives, and competitive intelligence, creating a consistent operating rhythm from a previously ad hoc process.
- Built lender qualification frameworks to convert relationship capital into repeatable deal flow.

Market Executive, Innovation Economy | J.P. Morgan

Washington, DC | May 2023 - September 2024

Team Leadership: Built and led startup banking practice from zero post-SVB crisis

- Recruited, hired, and led seven direct reports across DC/Philadelphia, Chicago, and Atlanta markets, teaching a largely new-to-venture team how startup ecosystems form, how venture capital works, and how to stand out in a crowded market.
- Developed first-of-kind regional startup ecosystem roadmap mapping every JPM resource available to a company from early stage through IPO, lauded by Commercial Bank senior leadership as a model for the national practice.
- Led national analyst program supporting 50-person national startup banking group, conducted performance evaluations, led regional strategic planning, and orchestrated \$150,000 regional budget allocation.

Portfolio Growth: Scaled personal portfolio from \$0 to \$40M across 50 companies in five months

- Competed internally across divisions to transfer neglected early-stage companies into the newly formed Startup Banking group, building leadership-approved rationale and negotiating cross-divisional handoffs.
- Established specialized focus on defense, industrial, and fintech verticals through targeted sponsorships and programming, leveraging prior government and ecosystem relationships to differentiate the regional practice.

Ecosystem Development: Designed and executed programming strategy to reposition J.P. Morgan as premier banking partner

- Produced 12 ecosystem events ranging from intimate founder dinners (5-10) to large-scale gatherings (250+), developing program topics, securing corporate partners, and executing panel discussions that built brand credibility in a market skeptical of JPM.

Vice President, Startup Banking | Silicon Valley Bank

Washington, DC | February 2022 - May 2023

Market Building & Growth: Established first-mover startup banking presence across five-state Mid-Atlantic region from zero

- Built regional portfolio to 250 early-stage companies representing \$100M+ in deposits through grassroots ecosystem development, founder relationships, and community partnerships.
- Increased client satisfaction (NPS) by 40% and exceeded annual new client acquisition target by 56%.

Crisis Leadership: Served as sole early-stage banker for five-state region during the March 2023 SVB collapse and FDIC receivership

- Managed individualized outreach across hundreds of founder, investor, and economic development relationships simultaneously, operating under legal constraints that prevented disclosure while founders and VCs looked to me as their only point of contact.
- Preserved regional relationships through personal reputation management, direct client communication, and press engagement, maintaining trust with media contacts who treated me as an individual separate from the institution.

Program Manager, Acceleration | U.S. Department of Defense **Washington, DC | April 2019 - February 2022**

Program Leadership: Rebuilt a previously failed startup innovation program within one of the world's largest bureaucracies

- Applied Business Model Canvas framework to rebuild program architecture from scratch, conducting stakeholder interviews, developing SOPs, marketing materials, and process maps. Presented findings to senior leadership for program inspection.
- Completed programs with the F-35 Joint Program Office, Space Force, Air Force, and groups focused on quantum and advanced fabrics, distributing \$35M+ in contracts and grants.
- Aligned budgets, authority (appropriations), and vehicles (SBIR/OTA) across complex stakeholder groups spanning DoD offices, contracting officials, program managers, venture capitalists, and startups.

Process Innovation: Engineered repeatable execution process that compressed program timelines by 42%

- Shifted burden of program readiness upstream to DoD offices, requiring pre-validation of budget, authority, and acquisition vehicles before program approval, eliminating downstream delays.
- Managed pipeline of 15-20 concurrent program concepts across military branches and allied forces.

Program Outcomes: Built trust across a three-way table where all parties had reasons to be skeptical

- Became the connective tissue between startups who assumed government moved too slowly, VCs skeptical of institutional commitment, and DoD program managers who needed private capital to advance their technology.
- Attracted 300+ applicants, increased contracts awarded by 47% and contract amounts by 635%.

Senior Consultant, Innovation | Nationwide Insurance **Columbus, OH | June 2015 - April 2019**

Program Leadership & Executive Operations: Chief of Staff on "Claims of the Future": a \$2.5M design thinking initiative

- Identified opportunity and built the thesis that Nationwide's multi-billion dollar claims operation, largely untouched for 25 years, would benefit from digital transformation, then led the end-to-end RFP process that resulted in selection of IDEO as design partner.
- Delivered bi-weekly SVP briefings covering cross-functional progress, coordinated read-ahead materials, and managed milestone-based funding releases, maintaining executive alignment throughout a multi-year engagement.
- Coordinated cross-functional initiative spanning procurement, legal, finance, IT, and 50+ internal stakeholders through process mapping, issue spotting in an environment where innovation carried real consequences for jobs and careers.
- Two digital experience prototypes advanced to production with 57% adoption in advanced testing.

Stakeholder & Diplomatic Management: Navigated a transformation that threatened established careers and organizational norms

- Worked in close partnership with senior leadership to map stakeholder dynamics alongside the project plan, determining who needed to be brought along, what tone to use, and where hard news needed delivering softly.
- Managed 6-10 IDEO members across cross-country working sessions and intensive design sprints, treating world-class practitioners as partners rather than vendors and absorbing masterclass-level lessons in executive communication and roadmapping.

SKILLS

AI & Automation: Agentic workflow design, prompt engineering, AI-assisted research and synthesis, automated data extraction and scoring systems. Tools include Claude, Cowork, Claude Code, Python, Git/GitHub, Tableau, SQL, Salesforce, Excel, Notion.

Business: Negotiation, executive communication, stakeholder management, cross-functional program leadership, strategic planning.

Languages: English (native), Portuguese (beginner), Spanish (beginner)

GitHub: <https://github.com/jojo-d-explorer>

EDUCATION

The Ohio State University	Columbus, OH
Master of Business Administration (MBA), Finance	2013 - 2015
Juris Doctor (JD), Alternative Dispute Resolution Master of Public Policy (MA), Public Finance	2008 - 2011
• Certificate of Alternative Dispute Resolution (U.S. Program Rank: #1 - Negotiation, Arbitration, Mediation)	
Bachelor of Arts (BA), Psychology	2004 - 2008

INTERESTS

Vinyl record collecting, historical fiction & literary journalism, abstract expressionist art